



YOU ARE **13 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
188 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

It's easy to see where your baby's bones are on an ultrasound because they show up as brighter areas. Other features may be harder to see. If you have a scan and are unsure what you are looking at, ask your doctor to interpret it for you.

“Relief, excitement, apprehension... it's normal to feel all this and more at this stage of your pregnancy.”

While you're undoubtedly feeling better physically, and probably have lots more energy, you may still be up and down emotionally. This is completely normal.

This stage of pregnancy can be a very emotional time: reaching the second trimester is a pregnancy milestone and coincides with seeing your baby on the scan (see [First ultrasound scan](#)). You know that, with the chances of miscarrying now being so minimal, you're really going to have a baby. However, like many pregnant women, you may find that the feeling of relief at reaching this stage is followed by occasional anxieties.

One good outlet for all this emotional energy is exercising, which you may find easier now that you're over the first trimester fatigue. Exercise releases endorphins, the feel-good hormones, and can improve your emotional as well as physical well-being; but always exercise safely (see [The impact of exercise on labor](#)).

THE IMPACT OF EXERCISE ON LABOR

Exercising may reduce the time you are in labor. Research has shown that women who exercise at a moderate to high intensity can cut their time in labor by up to three hours, and they tend to have less complicated deliveries than those who don't exercise.

LISTENING TO YOUR BODY

Check with your doctor whether there's any reason why you shouldn't be exercising; there are certain pregnancy conditions, such as [placenta previa](#) and the risk of premature labor, that may preclude you from exercising.

When exercising, always use your common sense—listen to your body and watch for symptoms that may indicate you are exercising too hard. Aerobic exercise is often tracked by measuring the heart rate, but this is difficult during pregnancy since there is a natural increase in your heart rate, even at rest. So the most effective way to keep your exercise at a safe level is the